What do mathematicians need to know about blogging?

Terence Tao · 9 August 2009

https://terrytao.wordpress.com/2009/08/09/what-do-mathematicians-need-to-know-about-blogging/

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John Baez has been invited to write a short opinion piece for the Notices of the AMS to report about the maths blogging phenomenon to the wider mathematical community, and in the spirit of that phenomenon, has opened up a blog post to solicit input for that piece, over at the n-Category café. Given that the readers here are, by definition, familiar with mathematical blogging, I thought that some of you might like to visit that thread to share your own thoughts on the advantages and disadvantages of this mode of mathematical communication.

Comments (4)

Bob · 9 August 2009

Being a math teacher myself, and having read more than a few other math blogs, I think the major thing for new bloggers to remember is that they need to make sure that they're clear on what they talk about, and to actively link to other articles they've written. Many people jump into a topic without really prepping the reader. That's no good.

Anonymous · 10 August 2009

Wonderful medium to keep people informed about advances in our subject. It complements conferences and conversations with clued-in colleagues. This blog (and at least one or two others) are a great service to the worldwide mathematical community.

Maria H. Andersen · 21 August 2009

I think there may be a difference between how mathematicians and how math instructors use blogging. For those of us with a primary teaching focus, math blogs are a great way to find relevant material for our classes, to learn about new technologies that we can use to teach online, and to bounce instructional ideas off of colleagues.

I suspect that the AMS article will be focused on blogging for research, but just for the record, there is a second tier of blogging "mathematicians" out there.

Two quick updates « What's new · 30 September 2009

[...] In a previous post, I noted John Baez's thread discussing his incipient article to the Notices of the AMS, "What do mathematicians need to know about blogging?". John has now completed an initial draft of his article and is welcoming comments on it here. [...]